To be fair, the United States must give the democratic government we demanded the room to resolve its own issues, less it be seen as merely a pawn. But if the reported deal with Baitullah Mehsud fails I hope the government in Islamabad will vigorously pursue the people who intend nothing but ill for their country. Too many innocent Pakistanis have died at the hands of terrorist for them to do otherwise. The United States needs the continued co-operation of Pakistan in the fight against terrorism, but we also need to give the government enough political space that the fight becomes their as much as ours. To date, the Bush administration has not shown the deftness necessary to accomplish such a feat, but then again, we can always pray.

Chairman Berman. The time of the gentleman has expired. And we now turn to our distinguished panel of witnesses.

First we will hear from Ambassador Richard Holbrooke, current vice chairman of Perseus, a leading private equity firm. *Ambassador Holbrooke* has served in numerous capacities for the United States Government. Most recently he was the United States Ambassador to the United Nations where he was also a member of President Clinton's cabinet. In addition, as Assistant Secretary of State for Europe he was the chief architect to the 1995 Dayton Peace Agreement that ended the war in Bosnia.

Appropriate for this hearing, Ambassador Holbrooke recently took a trip to Pakistan to get his sense of the political dynamics at play. His insights will be invaluable to this committee, having served both within and outside the administration on such high profile foreign policy issues.

Next we will hear from Ambassador Tom Pickering. Ambassador Pickring is currently vice chairman at Hills and Company which provides advice and counsel to a number of U.S. enterprises. Ambassador Pickring has an exemplary public service career that has spanned five decades, including service as the United States Ambassador to the United Nations, and Under Secretary of State for Political Affairs. And since I got to Congress, Ambassador, every hot spot from Latin America and Central America to the Middle East to India and around the world. So he is well-versed on the issues confronting the U.S. national security objectives in the region, and I look forward to his frank assessment on today's hearing topic.

And, finally, we welcome the presence of General James Jones, who is currently President and CEO of the U.S. Chamber Institute for 21st Century Energy. General Jones is a decorated combat veteran who retired after 40 years of active duty service. General Jones most recently served as the 32nd Commandant of the Marine Corps and the Supreme Allied Commander Europe. He has worked closely with government, business and civic leaders in an effort to protect and advance United States and allied interests around the world, most recently on issues dealing with South Asia.

Along with Ambassador Pickring, General Jones was a co-author of a report released by the Afghanistan Study Group which in part focused on the threats posed by the tribal regions of Pakistan. General Jones, we are happy to have you here today.

Ambassador Holbrooke, your entire statement will be part of the record. And we await your testimony.

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